M16 Glucagon

Scope of Practice	EMT
Classification	• Hormone
Usual Presentation	• 1mg/1ml vial
Mechanism of Action	• Glucagon stimulates glycogenolysis (the breakdown of glycogen into glucose) predominantly in the liver, increasing blood glucose levels.
Indications	• Hypoglycemia • Beta Blocker overdose • Calcium Channel Blocker Overdose
Contraindications	• Known allergy
Precautions	• Patients where glycogen stores may be depleted (see additional information)
Side Effects	• Reported difficulty maintaining stable glucose levels for up to two weeks following administration

Adult Dose & Administration	**Hypoglycemia**
	• 1mg IM/SC
	Betablocker & Calcium Chanel Blocker Overdose
	• 1mg IM.
	  • Administer up to 5mg IM (at different injection sites) if additional IM glucagon is available.
	  • Repeat every 10-15 minutes if required.

Pediatric Dose & Administration	**Hypoglycemia** • >6 years (or >25kg):1mg IM/SC • <6 years (or <25kg): 0.5mg IM/SC **Betablocker & Calcium Chanel Blocker Overdose** • >6 years (or >25kg): 1mg IM. • <6years (or <25kg): 0.5mg IM. • Repeat every 10-15 minutes if required.
Use in Pregnancy and Lactation	• Pregnancy: Safety has not been established. However, glucagon should be administered if clinically indicated. • Lactation: Safety has not been established. If essential to be administered, the mother should be advised to stop breast feeding until advised by their physician.

Additional Information	• Patient whose glycogen stores may already be depleted:
	  • Non-diabetics
	  • Septic patients
	  • Young children
	  • Following extreme exercise
	  • Has not eaten in more than 12 hours
	  • Adrenal insufficiency
	  • Chronic hypoglycemia
	  • Alcohol induced hypoglycemia
	• Glucagon is unlikely to be effective in these patients, however glucagon may be considered if no IV access can be obtained, the patient remains significantly hypoglycemic, and/or a reduced level of consciousness is causing airway, breathing or circulatory compromise.